

PROVING A POINT
Punjab CM Bhagwant Mann

HARDIK CHHABRA

hectare. The fields of Punjab produce about 19 per cent of the nation's wheat and 12 per cent of its paddy. The central agencies procure 85 per cent of the produce on a declared minimum support price (MSP). Punjab has the fortune of having several rivers flowing through it, but even so, a large part of the hinterland is still dependent on groundwater, with diesel- and electric-run borewell pumps used to irrigate the fields. The farmers continue to be in monocrop mode and tied to water-guzzling crops such as paddy. Less than 10 per cent of the fields cultivate cash crops. The ministry of agriculture data also shows that rural households in Punjab have an average debt stress of Rs 1.98 lakh.

Most Improved Big State: Telangana

Telangana is determined to earn the 'rice bowl of India' epithet in paddy procurement, surpassing Punjab, in a year or two. In 2020-21, it set a new record by procuring 141,000 crore tonnes. The state's gross cropped area has gone up by 64 per cent from 13 million acres in 2014 to 21.5 million acres in 2021-22. A slew of initiatives by Chief Minister K. Chandrashekar Rao have enabled this impressive growth. This includes irrigation projects, providing the Rythu Bandhu investment support, Rythu Bima insurance cover, uninterrupted free power supply and other measures. "Irrigation and other farmer issues are the government's priorities in rural areas. The average growth of the agri sector in the state was 15.8 per cent over the past seven years; the national average was 8.5 per cent,"

PUNJAB'S FIELDS STILL PRODUCE 19 PER CENT OF INDIA'S WHEAT, AND 12 PER CENT OF ITS PADDY

BEST PERFORMING BIG STATES AGRICULTURE

RANK 2022	STATE	SCORE OUT OF 320	RANK 2021
1	PUNJAB	232.0	1
2	UTTARAKHAND	202.0	8
3	HARYANA	200.8	2
4	ANDHRA PRADESH	200.1	3
5	TELANGANA	193.3	4
6	MADHYA PRADESH	190.6	6
7	GUJARAT	184.4	10
8	WEST BENGAL	183.8	7
9	TAMIL NADU	174.1	5
10	MAHARASHTRA	156.8	17
11	UTTAR PRADESH	155.8	12
12	HIMACHAL PRADESH	148.1	9
13	ASSAM	140.1	19
14	JHARKHAND	140.0	14
15	KARNATAKA	137.5	18
16	RAJASTHAN	131.6	15
17	BIHAR	129.2	16
18	ODISHA	128.7	13
19	CHHATTISGARH	121.7	11
20	KERALA	110.1	20

BEST PERFORMING SMALL STATES AGRICULTURE

RANK 2022	STATE	SCORE OUT OF 320	RANK 2021
1	PUDUCHERRY	200.3	3
2	TRIPURA	196.5	1
3	SIKKIM	192.6	4
4	ARUNACHAL PRADESH	180.7	2
5	MIZORAM	170.8	7
6	NAGALAND	163.5	5
7	MEGHALAYA	146.7	6
8	GOA	129.0	8
9	MANIPUR	127.2	9

Parameters: Money spent on agriculture in last budget compared to area of agriculture and population invested in agriculture, contribution of agriculture to GDP, agriculture GSDP/rural population, % of area irrigated of the total cultivated land, productivity–crop produced vs land and population involved, loans extended to agriculture/ households cultivating land, % of cropped area under cash crops
Note: Delhi was not considered under Agriculture category